Rail travel reservations - operating guide

CURRENT 2026; effective 1 August 2026

Scope: Business rail journeys and fare restrictions. This is fictional Meridian Works guidance. The following responsibilities apply only to the named activity, not to other procedures with similar labels.

When a business journey moves to a later day, the travel coordinator checks ticket exchange conditions before cancelling the existing ticket.

Fare RAIL-236 permits exchange before departure only; RAIL-263 permits a post-departure credit application.

The coordinator records what actually happened, identifies the responsible owner and checks the applicable route. A similarly numbered form is not interchangeable with the recorded form. For a rejected submission, retain the original request and obtain corrected evidence rather than creating a replacement event.

Registry RAIL-337: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry RAIL-348: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry RAIL-359: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry RAIL-370: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

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Eligibility and operational limits. Select the named cohort and activity before applying a period or amount; different entitlements in this section are not substitutes.

Trainees book standard carriage; executives travelling on client business may book first class.

A separately charged rail seat reservation may be approved up to GBP 8.

A valid request contains its underlying event date and the scope used for the calculation. Reviewers distinguish acknowledgement, completion and storage periods. A deadline for submitting evidence is not a service restoration promise. If the activity or group is not stated, escalate the question rather than borrowing a nearby rule.

Registry RAIL-381: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry RAIL-392: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry RAIL-403: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry RAIL-414: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

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Document control: this 2026 operating guide is CURRENT and effective from 1 August 2026. The 2024 edition is archived and superseded. No forecast for a later year is stated.

The latest 2026 rail travel rule requires exchange requests four hours before departure.

Fare rights govern the carrier ticket. Reimbursement deadlines are set by travel accounts.

The reference annex has its own scope. Staff should distinguish operational permission from commercial price, evidence retention and service specifications. Publication of a code or a process owner does not create a missing technical limit or a financial guarantee.

Amendment log: this edition consolidates the current timing rule and ownership path. Historical examples remain in the archive for traceability. They are not exceptions to the current rule. A request citing an older edition must be checked against the effective document before execution.